

EMPRESS DOWAGER CIXI

After the death of Emperor Xianfeng in 1861, his widow, Cixi, became regent for her son Tongzhi and then, in 1875, for her nephew Guangxu. She controlled the country for 47 years until her death in 1908. The Empress resisted Western influence, supporting the Boxer Rebellion against foreign domination, but attempted to reform Qing China during its difficult final years.



WARS AND REBELLIONS

1661–1722

The second Qing emperor Kangxi reestablishes Chinese dominance over Mongolia and Tibet. He also conquers the Kingdom of Dongning in present-day Taiwan.

1839–1842

The Qing are defeated in the First Opium War with Britain. Under the terms of the Treaty of Nanking that followed, foreign-run treaty ports open up China to international trade.

1850–1864

The long-running Taiping Rebellion to overthrow Manchu rule weakens the Qing Dynasty. Around 50 million people die during this period.

1899–1901

The Boxer Rebellion, a revolt by a peasant rebel group against foreign and Christian influence in the Qing Empire, breaks out. An international force invades Beijing to suppress it.

1911–1912

Frustrated by the slow pace of change in China, revolutionaries start uprisings across the country, leading to the fall of the Qing Dynasty.

1750–1900

EVERYDAY LIFE

In 1645, the Qing government ordered that all men had to wear their hair in a style called a queue. Hair on top of the scalp had to be grown long and then braided, while the front portion of the head was shaved.

